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Hiring Team
Quillstone Payments

Application: Machine Learning Engineer - Customer Support AI

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer - Customer Support AI role at Quillstone Payments. I bring six years in analytics and data science, including over four years building models and experiments at Thistlebox. As I move towards machine learning engineering, I offer practical experience with models used in business operations, strong Python and statistical skills, and a disciplined approach to evaluating whether a model delivers useful results.

At Thistlebox, I built a weekly recipe-level demand forecasting model using LightGBM and calendar features. Operations uses it to order ingredients; forecast error (WAPE) fell from 23% to 14%, with an estimated 9% reduction in food waste. I also built an XGBoost churn propensity model for targeting retention offers and validated uplift with a holdout. These projects demonstrate feature engineering, model evaluation and the ability to connect predictive performance with operational outcomes, all relevant to your team's work on support AI.

Alongside modelling, I write production SQL in BigQuery and maintain dbt models for the analytics layer. I design and analyse approximately 40 A/B tests each year for growth and product teams, built the team's sequential testing calculator, and present results to leadership monthly. This combination of data preparation, experimentation and communication would support collaboration with your backend engineers, data scientists and product managers, particularly when assessing model accuracy and the effectiveness of support automation.

Quillstone's focus on helping merchants get answers quickly gives this role a clear measure of practical value. Your emphasis on ownership, pragmatism and sharing context aligns with the way my work connects analysis to decisions made by operations, product teams and leadership. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my applied machine learning experience and statistical foundation could contribute to your Customer Operations AI team.

Yours sincerely,
Tobias Mwangi-Hartley